COURSE SLIDES · WSQ

Unlocking Business Potential with Strategic Negotiation Tactics



WSQ Course Code: TGS-2023020567

Conducted by Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd · UEN 201200696W

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COURSE ADMINISTRATION

Welcome, Outcomes and Assessment

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Digital Attendance (Mandatory)

1

AM, PM and Assessment

Complete every SSG digital-attendance event shown by the trainer.

2

Scan the QR code

Use the mobile camera and submit the generated attendance form.

3

Verify submission

Tell the trainer immediately if the confirmation does not appear.

4

Funding condition

At least 75% attendance and a Competent result are required.

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YOUR TRAINER · COURSE FACILITATOR

How the Workshop Will Run



Dr. Alfred Ang

Course Facilitator · Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

WORKSHOP ROLE

Guide discussion, challenge assumptions and connect evidence to workplace decisions

LEARNING FOCUS

Preparation, influence, conflict, closure and post-negotiation evaluation

FACILITATION APPROACH

Case-based practice, reflection, feedback and evidence-led debrief

ASSESSMENT BOUNDARY

Clarifies instructions but does not coach assessed responses

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YOUR TRAINER

About the Trainer



Dr. Alfred Ang

Principal Trainer · Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

ROLE
Principal Trainer and course facilitator

SPECIALISMS
Business negotiation, strategy and applied decision-making

DELIVERY
WSQ professional development and workplace application

CONTACT
enquiry@tertiaryinfotech.com

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INTRODUCTION

Let's Know Each Other

1

Role

Your organisation, function and negotiation responsibilities.

2

Negotiation experience

One supplier, customer or workplace agreement you handled.

3

Learning goal

The negotiation situation or behaviour you want to strengthen.

4

Case lens

One stakeholder whose priorities you will represent.

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HOUSEKEEPING

Ground Rules

1. **Participate**
   Challenge assumptions and contribute evidence.

2. **Respect**
   Disagree with ideas, not people.

3. **Confidentiality**
   Use public or course data only; do not disclose live commercial information.

4. **Devices**
   Silent mode; step out quietly if needed.

5. **Time**
   Return from breaks promptly.

6. **Attendance**
   Maintain the required SSG attendance record.

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LESSON PLAN

Course Outline — 2 Days

Day 1

- Day 1 — Prepare the position and team

– Topic 1: outcomes, BATNA, context, roles and research

– Activities 1–5: supplier, SaaS, lease, distribution and job offer

– Build evidence-backed packages and authority limits

Day 2

- Day 2 — Apply tactics, close and evaluate

– Topic 2: opening, listening, tactics, impasse and closure

– Activities 6–10: agency, logistics, construction, investment and partnership

– WA 4–5pm · Case Study 5–6pm

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WHAT YOU WILL ACHIEVE

Learning Outcomes

1

LO1

Identify negotiation outcomes, the context of negotiation and relevant background information required to prepare for negotiation.

2

LO2

Apply negotiation techniques during negotiation and record negotiations for post-negotiation evaluation.

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TSC ALIGNMENT

Skills Framework Alignment

ICT-BIN-3105-1

- Business Negotiation
- WSQ competency alignment

Knowledge K1–K6

• objectives · context · culture · interpersonal · communication · precedent

Abilities A1–A5

• outcomes · roles · background · tactics · records

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BEFORE ASSESSMENT

Briefing for Assessment

1

Individual

No discussion, photography or recording.

2

Open book

Use slides, Learner Guide and approved course materials only.

3

Submission

Answer in your own words and upload the completed document to the LMS.

4

Conduct

Phones and other materials under the table; follow assessor instructions.

5

Outcome

Competent or Not Yet Competent; reassessment and appeal are available.

6

Sign-off

Complete digital attendance and sign the Assessment Summary Record.

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FINAL ASSESSMENT

Assessment and Funding

WA-SAQ · 1 hour

- 6 open-ended questions
- Covers K1–K6
- Open book

Case Study · 1 hour

- 2 integrated questions
- Covers A1–A5
- Open book

Competency

- Satisfactory evidence
- At least 75% attendance
- Appeal process available

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ON ASSESSMENT DAY

Assessment Flow

1. TRAQOM / SSG attendance
2. Assessment digital attendance
3. Sit WA then Case Study
4. Submit answers on the LMS
5. Sign the Assessment Summary Record

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HANDS-ON MATERIALS

Access the Course Activities

https://github.com/tertiarycourses/TGS-2023020567-Unlocking-Business-Potential-with-Strategic-Negotiation-Tactics

Clone

Clone the repository, then open the activities folder.

Download ZIP

Use GitHub Code → Download ZIP when Git is unavailable.

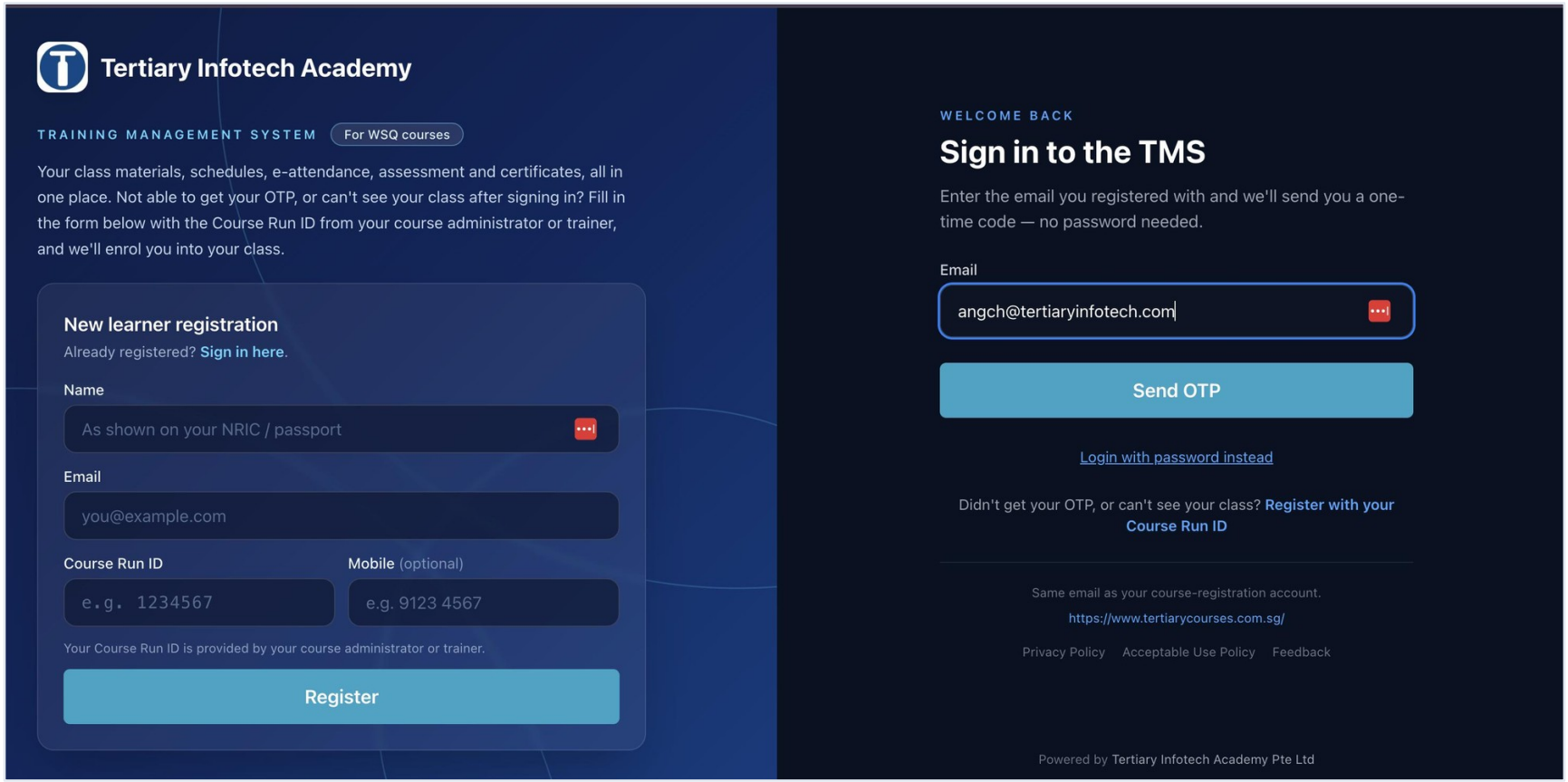
One folder each

Every activity contains scenario, data, questions, procedure and acceptance evidence.

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COURSE PORTAL

Login to LMS and Download Course Material



Log in at lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com with your registered email and the OTP sent to your inbox, then open this course to download the slides and Learner Guide.

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COURSEWARE AND ASSESSMENT

Download Course Material

https://lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com/

1 · Sign in

Open the LMS with your registered email and password or OTP.

2 · Open course

Select this TGS course from your enrolled courses.

3 · Download

Download slides and the Learner Guide; assessments are completed on the LMS.

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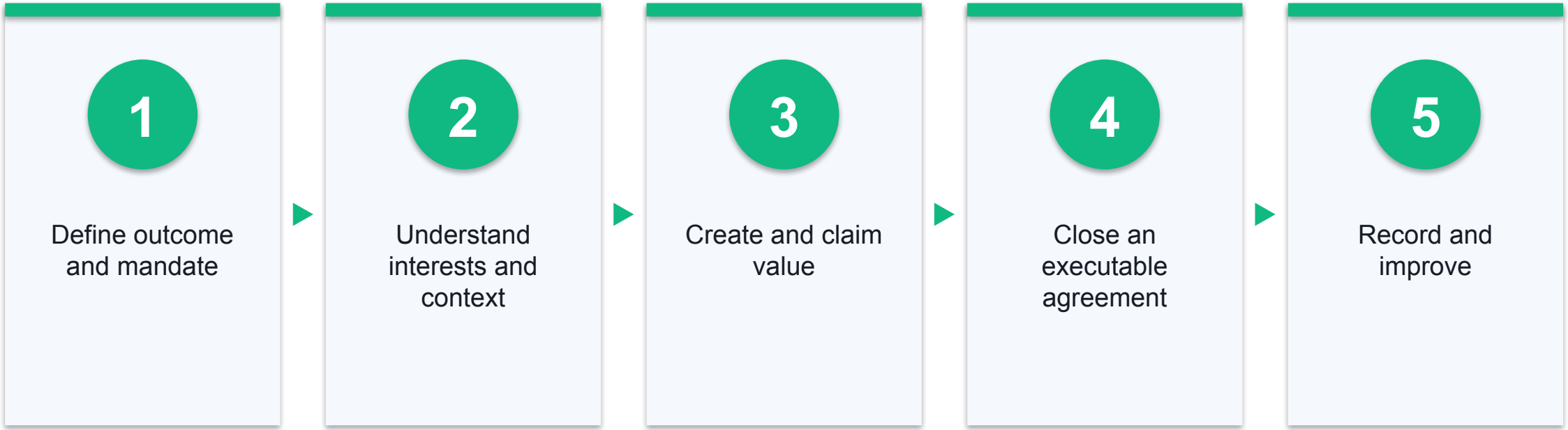
CORE MODEL

Prepare · Connect · Trade · Close · Learn

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END-TO-END VIEW

The strategic negotiation lifecycle



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NEGOTIATION DISCIPLINE

Evidence before confidence

1

Verified fact

Contract, benchmark, performance record or stated requirement with source and date.

2

Working hypothesis

A plausible explanation or interest that must be tested through questions.

3

Training assumption

A simulated input used only for learning and clearly labelled.

4

Decision record

Offer, condition, rationale, owner and authority captured at the time.

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COURSE MODEL

Firm on interests. Flexible on options.

Good negotiation protects legitimate limits while searching creatively for terms both sides can implement.

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01

LEARNING UNIT 01 · K1 · K2 · K3 · A1 · A2 · A3

Preparation for Negotiation

Outcomes · context · roles · research · BATNA · culture · planning

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Key Concepts — Preparation for Negotiation

1

Outcome

Define the target, reservation point, relationship goal and implementation needs.

2

Context

Map parties, issues, authority, constraints, precedents and the wider commercial setting.

3

Alternatives

A credible BATNA creates walk-away discipline and strengthens judgement.

4

Preparation

Research interests, options, criteria, culture, risks and team roles before the meeting.

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TOPIC 01 · K1 · K2 · K3 · A1 · A2 · A3

Preparation converts pressure into choice.

A negotiator with clear priorities and alternatives can stay curious without becoming careless.

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Negotiation is everywhere

1

Commercial

Supplier terms, customer contracts, leases, licensing and partnerships.

2

Workplace

Resources, deadlines, roles, salary, scope and performance expectations.

3

Strategic

Alliances, acquisitions, restructures and multi-party commitments.

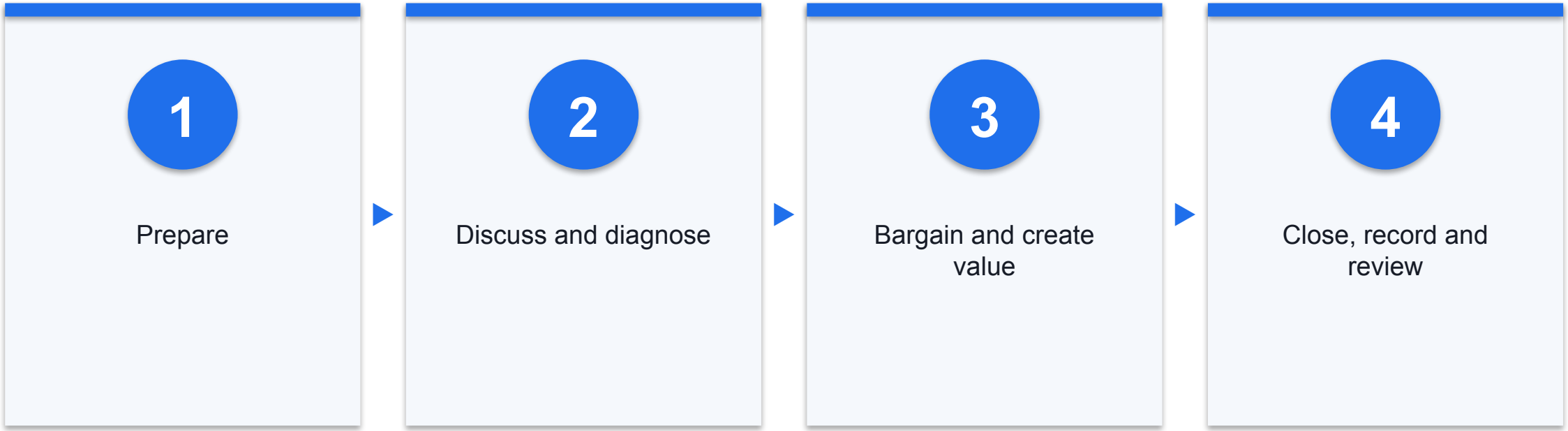
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Everyday

Any dialogue where parties seek agreement despite differing preferences.

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A four-stage negotiation process



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Positions and interests

Perspective A

- A position states what a party says it wants.
- Arguing positions can lock both sides into face-saving.
- Treat a position as an opening signal, not the full diagnosis.

Perspective B

- An interest explains why an outcome matters.
- Questions reveal priorities, fears, constraints and tradeable differences.
- Interests create room for options that positions conceal.

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Three bargaining situations

Distributive

- Divide a fixed amount; protect the reservation point and claim value.

Integrative

- Trade differences in priorities, timing, risk or capability to create value.

Mixed-motive

- Most business deals require both value creation and value claiming.

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Define the outcome hierarchy

1

Must-have

A condition required for authority, viability, safety or compliance.

2

Target

A challenging but supportable result used to guide proposals.

3

Tradeable

A term you can exchange because it matters more to the other side.

4

Relationship

Trust, reputation and future cooperation that should survive the deal.

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BATNA, WATNA, reservation point and ZOPA

1

BATNA

Best course of action if this negotiation produces no agreement.

2

WATNA

Credible downside if talks fail; useful for risk awareness, not as a target.

3

Reservation point

Worst acceptable negotiated outcome before the BATNA is better.

4

ZOPA

Range where both parties prefer an agreement to their alternatives.

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Strengthen your BATNA



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TOPIC 01 · K1 · K2 · K3 · A1 · A2 · A3

Your BATNA is not a threat.

It is the decision standard that protects you from accepting a deal worse than a realistic alternative.

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Map the negotiation context

1

Parties

Decision-makers, users, advisers, influencers, blockers and absent stakeholders.

2

Issues

Price, scope, quality, timing, risk, governance, service and future options.

3

Constraints

Budget, policy, regulation, deadlines, capacity and approval limits.

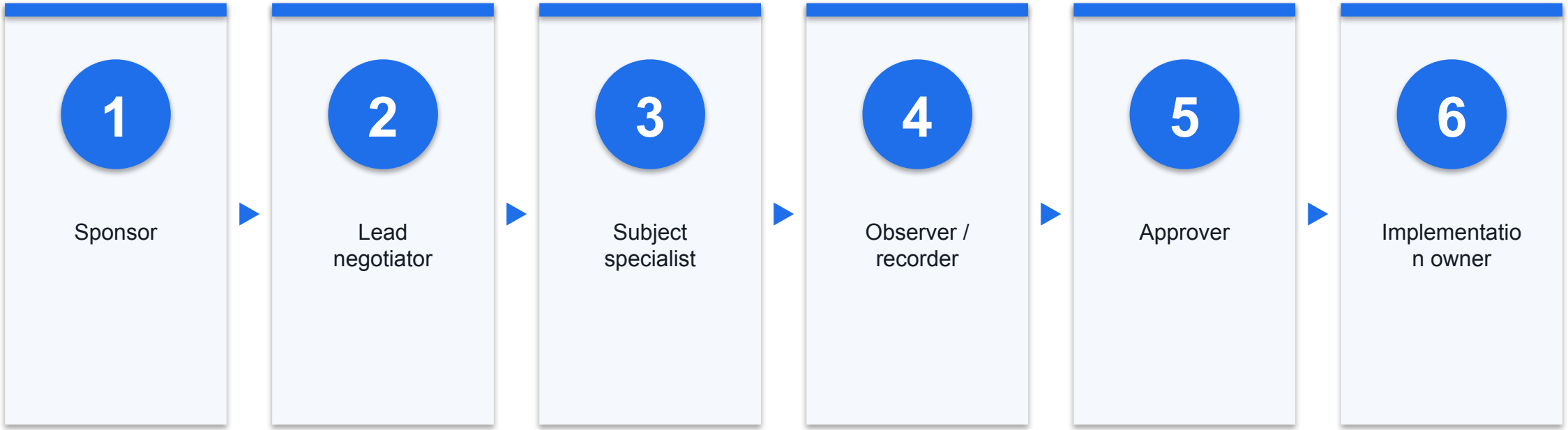
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History

Prior deals, promises, disputes, precedents and implementation performance.

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Stakeholder and authority map



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Roles and responsibilities

Perspective A

- The lead manages agenda, process, questions and package movement.
- Subject specialists test claims and explain operational consequences.
- A recorder captures proposals, rationale, conditions and open items.

Perspective B

- The sponsor sets objectives, mandate and escalation boundaries.
- The approver confirms commitments inside delegated authority.
- The implementation owner tests whether promises can be delivered.

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A negotiation mandate

1

Authority

What may be agreed at the table and what needs approval.

2

Limits

Reservation points, legal red lines and prohibited commitments.

3

Escalation

Who decides when assumptions, risk or value changes materially.

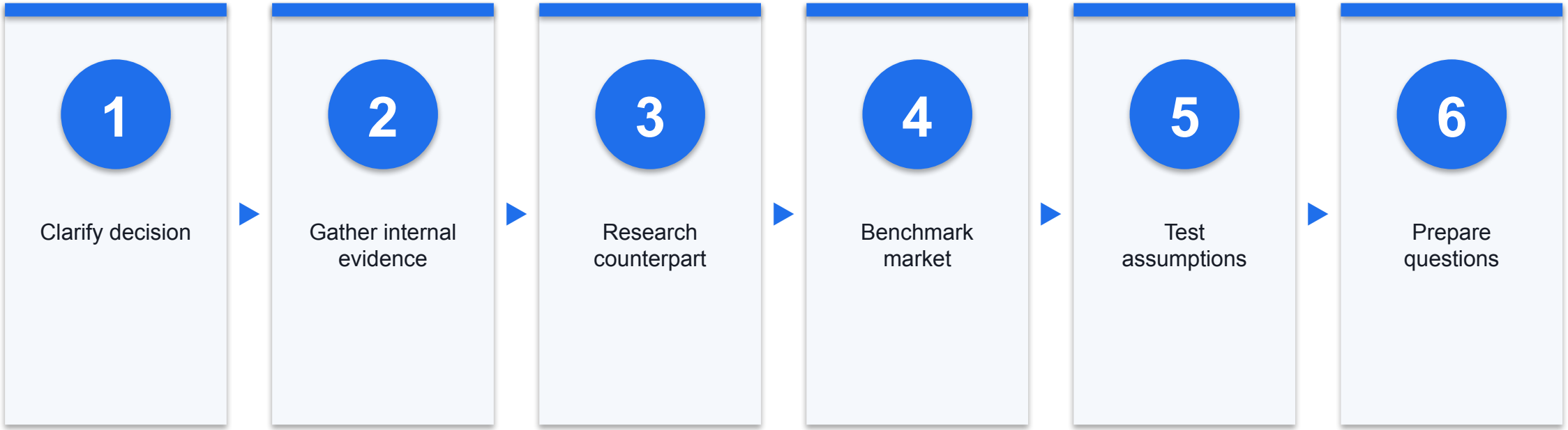
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Communication

Who may speak externally and how internal alignment is maintained.

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Background research sequence



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Research the other party

1

Business model

Revenue, costs, customers, dependencies and current priorities.

2

Likely interests

What success, risk and internal credibility may mean to them.

3

Constraints

Budget cycle, approvals, capacity, regulation and alternatives.

4

Signals

Public commitments, prior behaviour and terms they repeatedly protect.

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Objective criteria and precedent

Perspective A

- Use market rates, independent benchmarks, policy, expert evidence and comparable deals.
- Explain why the criterion is relevant and how it should be applied.
- Choose criteria before knowing which side they favour.

Perspective B

- A precedent can guide consistency but may reflect a different context.
- Compare scope, timing, risk, volume and relationship before relying on it.
- Document why a precedent applies—or why a justified exception is needed.

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Build an issue-priority matrix

1

High / high

Core issues for both sides; seek evidence and creative packages.

2

High / low

Protect what matters to you and exchange value rather than concede.

3

Low / high

Low-cost terms you may trade for higher-priority gains.

4

Low / low

Resolve efficiently so attention remains on consequential issues.

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Plan concessions before pressure arrives

Sequence

- Move from lower-cost to higher-cost concessions deliberately.

Condition

- Use if–then trades; never give without receiving or learning.

Signal

- Smaller, slower movement communicates proximity to the limit.

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Create value through differences

1

Priority

Trade an issue important to them for one important to you.

2

Time

Exchange payment timing, delivery sequence or contract duration.

3

Risk

Allocate warranties, guarantees, contingencies or performance incentives.

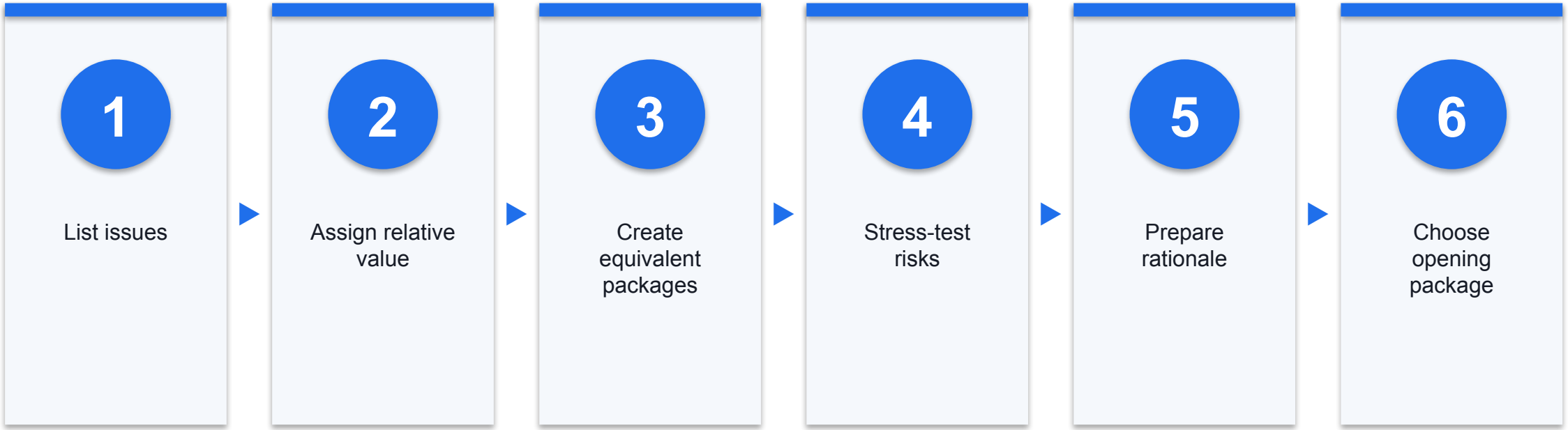
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Capability

Bundle training, data, service, access or implementation support.

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Develop package proposals



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Culture affects process—not stereotypes

1

Communication

Direct and indirect expression may signal disagreement differently.

2

Time

Pace, silence, deadlines and relationship-building vary by context.

3

Authority

Decision-making may be individual, hierarchical or consensus-based.

4

Face and trust

Public challenge, status and relationship history can shape candour.

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TOPIC 01 · K1 · K2 · K3 · A1 · A2 · A3

Use cultural hypotheses, then verify them.

Ask respectful process questions and adapt to the individual; nationality is never a complete behavioural forecast.

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Venue, time and agenda

1

Venue

Choose privacy, accessibility, neutrality and access to evidence—not superstition.

2

Timing

Allow preparation, approvals and breaks; avoid artificial urgency.

3

Agenda

Sequence information, issues, decisions and ownership transparently.

4

Mode

Plan document sharing, sidebars and signals for in-person or virtual talks.

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Information sharing

Perspective A

- Share facts needed to diagnose interests, generate options and implement a deal.
- Correct material misstatements and meet legal or ethical disclosure duties.
- Use staged reciprocity: disclose purposefully and test trust over time.

Perspective B

- Protect privileged data, trade secrets, reservation points and third-party information.
- Do not bluff about authority, alternatives or facts that can undermine trust.
- Agree confidentiality, data handling and record ownership before exchange.

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WORKPLACE APPLICATION

Applied Activities — Preparation for Negotiation

1

Activity 1

Renew a Critical Ingredient Supply Agreement · K1 · K2 · A1 · A3

2

Activity 2

Create a SaaS Renewal Team Mandate · K2 · A2 · A3

3

Activity 3

Prepare a Commercial Lease Renewal · K1 · K2 · A1 · A3

4

Activity 4

Plan a Singapore–Japan Distribution Partnership · K2 · K3 · A2 · A3

5

Activity 5

Design a Total-Reward Job Offer Negotiation · K1 · K2 · K3 · A1 · A3

6

Evidence boundary

Realistic commercial cases; fictional training inputs are clearly labelled.

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LEARNING UNIT 01 · K1 · K2 · A1 · A3

Renew a Critical Ingredient Supply Agreement

ACTIVITY 1

Act as the procurement team of a Singapore café group renewing a high-volume oat-milk supply agreement after demand growth and freight volatility.

You'll build

A negotiation outcome charter, BATNA comparison, issue-priority matrix and evidence request list.

Tools / evidence: Activity brief · negotiation worksheet · supplier benchmark data · evidence checklist

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ACTIVITY 1 · REAL-WORLD USE CASE

Case Scenario — Use Case and Training Guardrails

Business context

- Real-world use case: supplier renewals commonly combine price, volume, quality, continuity, forecasting and relationship interests. The scenario is a realistic composite rather than a claim about a named company.
- Source: https://asana.com/resources/negotiation-skills

Training assumptions / limits

- Current price is SGD 3.20 per litre; the supplier opens at SGD 3.62.
- Forecast demand is 12,000 litres monthly with a plus/minus 15% range.
- The alternative supplier can provide 7,000 litres at SGD 3.45 after a four-week onboarding period.

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ACTIVITY 1 · EDITABLE DECISION ARTIFACT

Outcome Control Panel

1 **Target**
Preferred supportable result

2 **Reservation**
Least acceptable complete package

3 **BATNA**
Best credible no-deal option

4 **ZOPA**
Possible overlap to test

5 **Tradeables**
Low-cost / high-value exchanges

6 **Evidence**
Facts needed before commitment

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ACTIVITY 1 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Activity Questions

1. What are the organisation's must-have, target, tradeable and relationship outcomes?
2. What is the best credible BATNA, and what evidence is needed to validate it?
3. Which issues could create value beyond unit price?
4. What opening package and reservation point should the sponsor approve?

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ACTIVITY 1 · ACCEPTANCE TEST

Renew a Critical Ingredient Supply Agreement

✅ Test it

The brief states an evidence-backed BATNA and reservation point, covers at least five issues, and separates targets from authority limits.

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LEARNING UNIT 01 · K2 · A2 · A3

Create a SaaS Renewal Team Mandate

ACTIVITY 2

Prepare an internal team to renegotiate a customer-relationship-management platform used by Sales, Service and Finance.

You'll build

A stakeholder map, RACI-style team charter, authority matrix and meeting protocol.

Tools / evidence: Stakeholder cards · authority matrix · issue log · role-play brief

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ACTIVITY 2 · REAL-WORLD USE CASE

Case Scenario — Use Case and Training Guardrails

Business context

- Real-world use case: SaaS renewals require commercial, technical, legal, security and end-user decisions. The company and figures are fictional training inputs.
- Source: https://builtin.com/articles/negotiation-skills

Training assumptions / limits

- The current annual contract value is SGD 240,000 for 300 users.
- Forty-five licences are inactive; migration to an alternative takes four months.
- The CFO may approve up to SGD 255,000 if three defined risk controls are included.

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ACTIVITY 2 · EDITABLE DECISION ARTIFACT

Team Mandate Map

1 **Sponsor**
Sets outcomes and mandate

2 **Lead**
Manages process and packages

3 **Specialists**
Test operational and commercial claims

4 **Recorder**
Captures offers and conditions

5 **Approver**
Confirms delegated commitment

6 **Escalation**
Handles material change

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ACTIVITY 2 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Activity Questions

1. Who owns the commercial outcome and who can bind the organisation?
2. Which specialists must attend, remain on call or review offline?
3. What commitments can the lead make without escalation?
4. How should the team handle internal disagreement during the vendor meeting?

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ACTIVITY 2 · ACCEPTANCE TEST

Create a SaaS Renewal Team Mandate

✅ Test it

Every critical issue has one accountable owner, one decision authority and one escalation route; no participant has conflicting authority.

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LEARNING UNIT 01 · K1 · K2 · A1 · A3

Prepare a Commercial Lease Renewal

ACTIVITY 3

Represent a retail operator renewing a suburban mall lease where rent, fit-out, operating hours and exit flexibility all affect value.

You'll build

A market benchmark table, total-occupancy-cost model, issue matrix and three equivalent packages.

Tools / evidence: Comparable-deal data · cost model · package worksheet · assumption log

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ACTIVITY 3 · REAL-WORLD USE CASE

Case Scenario — Use Case and Training Guardrails

Business context

- Real-world use case: commercial leases are negotiated across base rent, service charges, incentives, duration, use, fit-out and break rights. This is a realistic composite.
- Source: https://www.esade.edu/beyond/en/negotiation-techniques/

Training assumptions / limits

- Current base rent is SGD 18,000 monthly; the landlord opens at SGD 20,500.
- Three comparable units range from SGD 18,700 to SGD 19,600 after incentives.
- A relocation would cost SGD 180,000 and close the store for six weeks.

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ACTIVITY 3 · EDITABLE DECISION ARTIFACT

Lease Total-Value Model

1. **Base rent**
   Monthly fixed commitment
2. **Service charge**
   Operating-cost exposure
3. **Fit-out**
   Capital and downtime
4. **Rent-free**
   Cash-flow timing
5. **Break option**
   Flexibility value
6. **Risk**
   Footfall and exit assumptions

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ACTIVITY 3 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Activity Questions

1. Which comparables are genuinely relevant, and what adjustments are required?
2. What is the total value of rent, incentive, duration and break rights?
3. Which three packages are equivalent to Orchid but differently attractive to the landlord?
4. Which facts and assumptions should be disclosed, protected or verified?

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ACTIVITY 3 · ACCEPTANCE TEST

Prepare a Commercial Lease Renewal

✅ Test it

The proposal compares at least three complete packages on total value and cites adjusted, relevant criteria rather than a single rent number.

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LEARNING UNIT 01 · K2 · K3 · A2 · A3

Plan a Singapore–Japan Distribution Partnership

ACTIVITY 4

Prepare a Singapore health-food producer to meet a Japanese distributor about territory, forecasts, brand control and launch support.

You'll build

A cultural hypothesis sheet, process questions, bilingual agenda and relationship-risk plan.

Tools / evidence: Culture lens · stakeholder map · agenda template · communication protocol

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ACTIVITY 4 · REAL-WORLD USE CASE

Case Scenario — Use Case and Training Guardrails

Business context

- Real-world use case: international distribution negotiations may differ in communication, consensus, pacing, hierarchy and relationship-building. Individual behaviour must be verified rather than inferred from nationality.
- Source: https://www.pon.harvard.edu/daily/negotiation-skills-daily/types-of-negotiation-skills/

Training assumptions / limits

- Merlion can allocate one senior sponsor and one bilingual adviser.
- Product registration will take an estimated four to six months.
- The distributor seeks exclusivity but has not committed to minimum annual volume.

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ACTIVITY 4 · EDITABLE DECISION ARTIFACT

Cross-Cultural Hypothesis Map

Commercial and process lens

- Communication — Directness, silence and meaning
- Authority — Individual, hierarchy or consensus
- Pace — Relationship and decision timing

Relationship and decision lens

- Face — How disagreement is expressed
- Protocol — Agenda, status and formality
- Verify — Ask, observe and adapt

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ACTIVITY 4 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Activity Questions

1. Which cultural observations are facts, and which are hypotheses to test?
2. What respectful process questions should clarify authority and consensus?
3. How should the agenda balance relationship-building and commercial progress?
4. What safeguards prevent ambiguity across language versions?

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ACTIVITY 4 · ACCEPTANCE TEST

Plan a Singapore–Japan Distribution Partnership

✅ Test it

The plan contains at least five verification questions, a clear authority path and no unsupported statement that treats culture as destiny.

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LEARNING UNIT 01 · K1 · K2 · K3 · A1 · A3

Design a Total-Reward Job Offer Negotiation

ACTIVITY 5

Represent a growing technology SME hiring a regional operations manager where pay, flexibility, scope and start date have different value to each side.

You'll build

An employer mandate, candidate-interest hypothesis, compensation benchmark and three offer packages.

Tools / evidence: Benchmark extract · issue matrix · package planner · confidentiality checklist

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ACTIVITY 5 · REAL-WORLD USE CASE

Case Scenario — Use Case and Training Guardrails

Business context

- Real-world use case: job offers are negotiated across salary, bonus, equity, flexibility, role scope, development and start date. Personal information must be handled lawfully and respectfully.
- Source: https://sg.indeed.com/career-advice/career-development/negotiation-skills

Training assumptions / limits

- Approved base salary band is SGD 9,500–10,500 monthly.
- A sign-on award up to SGD 8,000 and training budget up to SGD 6,000 are available.
- The candidate's alternative offer is not verified and should not be treated as fact.

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ACTIVITY 5 · EDITABLE DECISION ARTIFACT

Total-Reward Package

1. **Base pay**
   Internal equity and market value
2. **Sign-on**
   Transition and timing
3. **Flexibility**
   Location and working pattern
4. **Development**
   Skills and progression
5. **Role scope**
   Authority and title review
6. **Start date**
   Urgency and notice constraints

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ACTIVITY 5 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Activity Questions

1. What are the employer's target, reservation point and non-financial priorities?
2. Which candidate interests should be tested rather than assumed?
3. How can three packages create choice while protecting internal equity?
4. Which candidate information is relevant, confidential or inappropriate to request?

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ACTIVITY 5 · ACCEPTANCE TEST

Design a Total-Reward Job Offer Negotiation

✅ Test it

All packages remain inside authority, address at least four issues, state objective criteria and avoid discriminatory or intrusive assumptions.

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LEARNING UNIT RECAP

Recap — Preparation for Negotiation

1. **Renew a Critical Ingredient Supply Agreement**
   Define commercial outcomes, BATNA, reservation point, ZOPA hypotheses and evidence needs before a supplier renewal.

2. **Create a SaaS Renewal Team Mandate**
   Assign negotiation roles, decision rights and escalation rules for a cross-functional software renewal.

3. **Prepare a Commercial Lease Renewal**
   Use market evidence and objective criteria to prepare a multi-issue lease negotiation.

4. **Plan a Singapore–Japan Distribution Partnership**
   Adapt process, communication and team roles for a cross-cultural distribution negotiation without relying on stereotypes.

5. **Design a Total-Reward Job Offer Negotiation**
   Prepare a multi-issue employment offer negotiation using priorities, alternatives, evidence and ethical information boundaries.

6. **Evidence habit**
   Separate facts, hypotheses, limits and training assumptions.

7. **Negotiation habit**
   Link every movement to an interest, condition, authority and record.

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End of Day 1

Return ready to open, listen, trade and close

02

LEARNING UNIT 02 · K4 · K5 · K6 · A4 · A5

Negotiation Tactics

Opening · listening · anchoring · framing · conflict · concessions · closure · evaluation

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Key Concepts — Negotiation Tactics

1

Connect

Use rapport, listening and empathy to understand interests and preserve working relationships.

2

Influence

Anchor and frame with evidence, not unsupported pressure or deception.

3

Trade

Make conditional, reciprocal concessions across issues of unequal value.

4

Record

Document offers, rationale, agreement, owners and learning for implementation and review.

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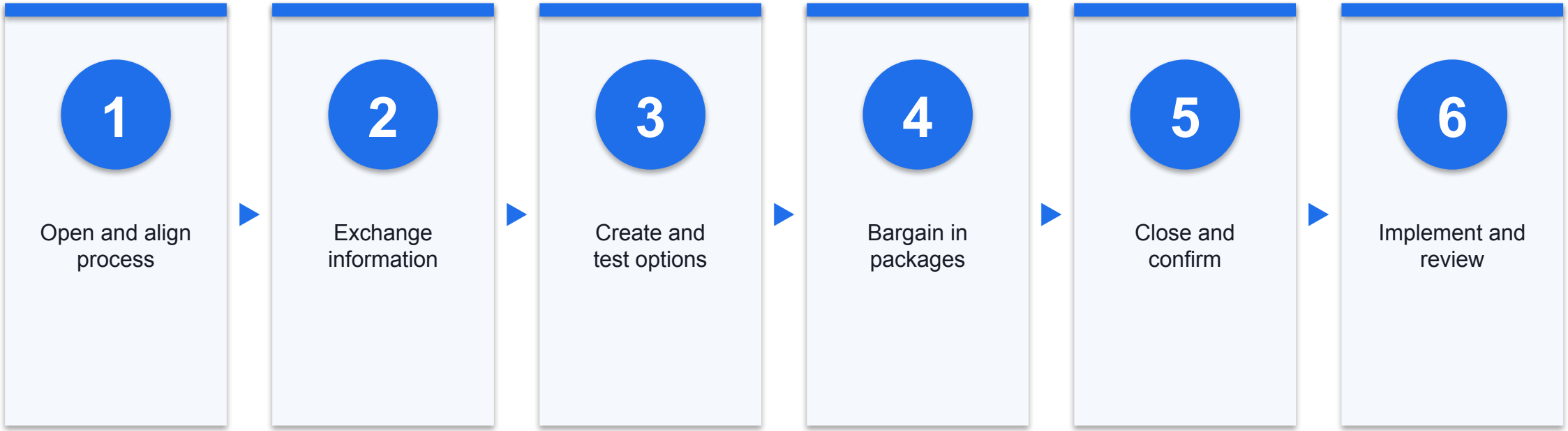
TOPIC 02 · K4 · K5 · K6 · A4 · A5

A tactic is useful only when it serves the strategy.

Short-term pressure that damages information, trust or implementation can destroy deal value.

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Conduct the negotiation



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TOPIC 02 · K4 · K5 · K6 · A4 · A5

Open the conversation

1

Rapport

Create a professional climate without pretending disagreement does not exist.

2

Purpose

State what decision or outcome the meeting should advance.

3

Process

Confirm agenda, roles, authority, timing and how decisions will be recorded.

4

Tone

Be firm on legitimate interests and respectful toward people.

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Should you make the first offer?

Perspective A

- A credible first offer can anchor discussion when you have strong information.
- It can frame the range and communicate ambition.
- Support it with logic, criteria and package terms.

Perspective B

- Wait when uncertainty is high and their opening may reveal valuable information.
- Do not let an extreme opening substitute for diagnosis.
- Prepare a counter-anchor before hearing their number.

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Design a defensible anchor

1

Ambitious

Leave room to move while remaining inside a supportable range.

2

Specific

A considered number can signal analysis, but precision must be real.

3

Explained

Link the proposal to value, evidence, risk and comparable standards.

4

Packaged

Anchor multiple terms so the conversation is not trapped on price.

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TOPIC 02 · K4 · K5 · K6 · A4 · A5

Avoid arbitrary round numbers—not round numbers themselves.

Precision helps only when it reflects genuine calculation; false precision weakens credibility.

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TOPIC 02 · K4 · K5 · K6 · A4 · A5

Frame without manipulating

1

Gain

Show benefits, opportunities and avoided costs created by agreement.

2

Loss

Explain credible consequences of delay or non-agreement without threats.

3

Fairness

Use objective standards that both parties can examine.

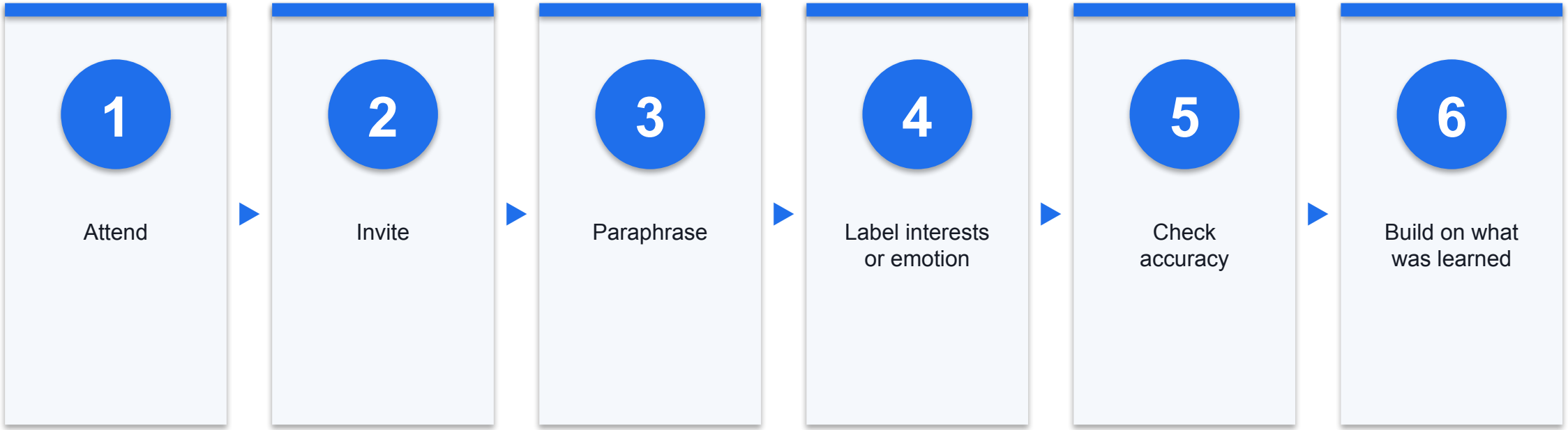
4

Choice

Present options and trade-offs rather than a disguised ultimatum.

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Active listening loop



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Questions that uncover value

1

Open

What matters most about implementation timing?

2

Diagnostic

What risk is the approval team trying to control?

3

Testing

If service credits increased, would contract length become flexible?

4

Clarifying

When you say reliable, which measure and threshold do you mean?

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Empathy and agreement

Perspective A

- Empathy means accurately understanding their perspective and emotion.
- Naming concerns can reduce defensiveness and improve information quality.
- You can acknowledge impact without accepting their proposed solution.

Perspective B

- Agreement is a decision to accept a term or claim.
- Premature agreement can hide implementation risk and unresolved interests.
- Use empathy to diagnose; use criteria and authority to decide.

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Emotional self-management

1

Notice

Track physical cues, trigger thoughts and rising urgency.

2

Pause

Use silence, a summary or a break before responding.

3

Reframe

Separate the person from the problem and return to interests.

4

Choose

Respond according to purpose, mandate and long-term consequences.

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Difficult behaviour patterns

Aggressive

- Set boundaries, slow the pace and return to evidence and process.

Avoidant

- Use specific questions, smaller decisions and clear follow-up dates.

Over-accommodating

- Test authority and interests; do not exploit a fragile yes.

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Respond to personal attacks

1

Do not mirror

Lower intensity and avoid defending every provocation.

2

Name impact

State that the behaviour prevents productive discussion.

3

Exit safely

Pause or end the meeting when threats, harassment or bad faith continue.

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Pressure tactics

1

Deadline

Verify whether it is real; compare the cost of delay with a rushed decision.

2

Competition

Ask what is comparable and avoid bidding against an unnamed alternative.

3

Ultimatum

Clarify whether the term is final, explore underlying constraints, use BATNA.

4

Nibble

Reopen the whole package or trade the late request for equivalent value.

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Delay and authority tactics

1

Limited authority

Confirm decision rights early and make proposals conditional on mutual approval.

2

Missing person

Request the decision-maker or agree a written escalation path.

3

Repeated delay

Use milestones, expiry dates and the cost of waiting.

4

Strategic pause

A legitimate break can improve judgement; document next steps.

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Good-cop / bad-cop and moral pressure

Perspective A

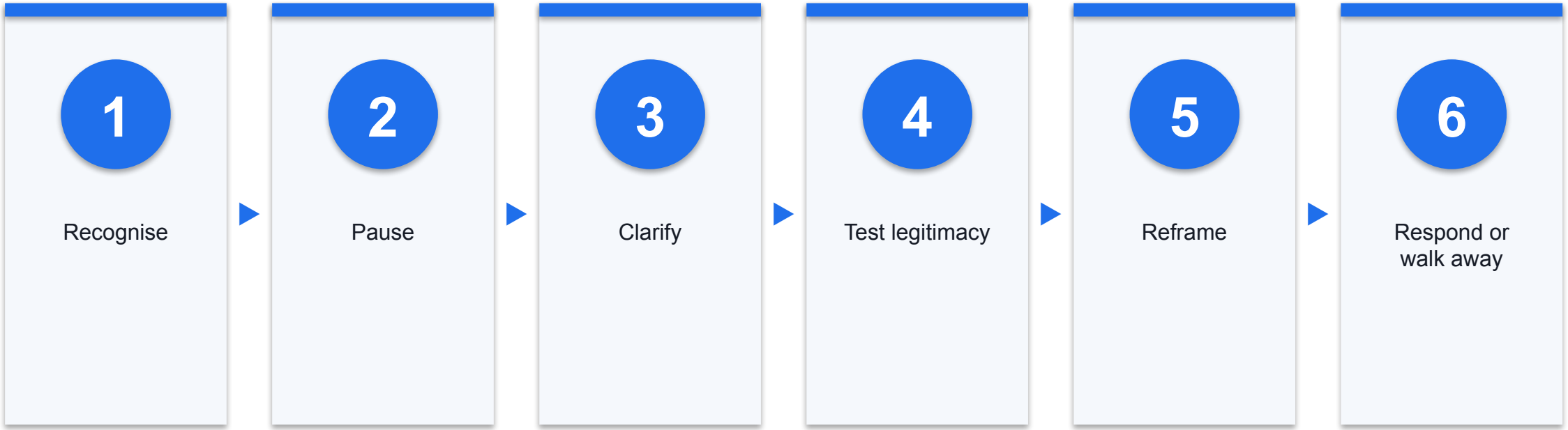
- Recognise the contrast effect: a merely poor offer can look attractive after an extreme demand.
- Evaluate every proposal against objectives, criteria and BATNA.
- Ask both representatives to confirm one accountable position.

Perspective B

- A moral appeal may surface values but can also shame or bypass evidence.
- Acknowledge the value, then examine reciprocal duties and facts.
- Do not accept a term outside authority to relieve social discomfort.

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A tactical response sequence



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Concession discipline

1

Reciprocal

Exchange movement for movement, information or commitment.

2

Conditional

Use if–then language so the package remains connected.

3

Recorded

Capture what moved, why, and whether earlier terms changed.

4

Diminishing

Reduce movement as the reservation point approaches.

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Trade—do not simply split

Logroll

- Trade issues with different priority rankings.

Contingent term

- Tie value to future outcomes when forecasts differ.

Add an issue

- Introduce scope, timing, risk or support to expand the solution space.

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Multiple equivalent simultaneous offers

1

Package A

Higher price with shorter term and stronger exit rights.

2

Package B

Lower price with volume commitment and forecast visibility.

3

Package C

Mid-price with performance incentives and shared implementation.

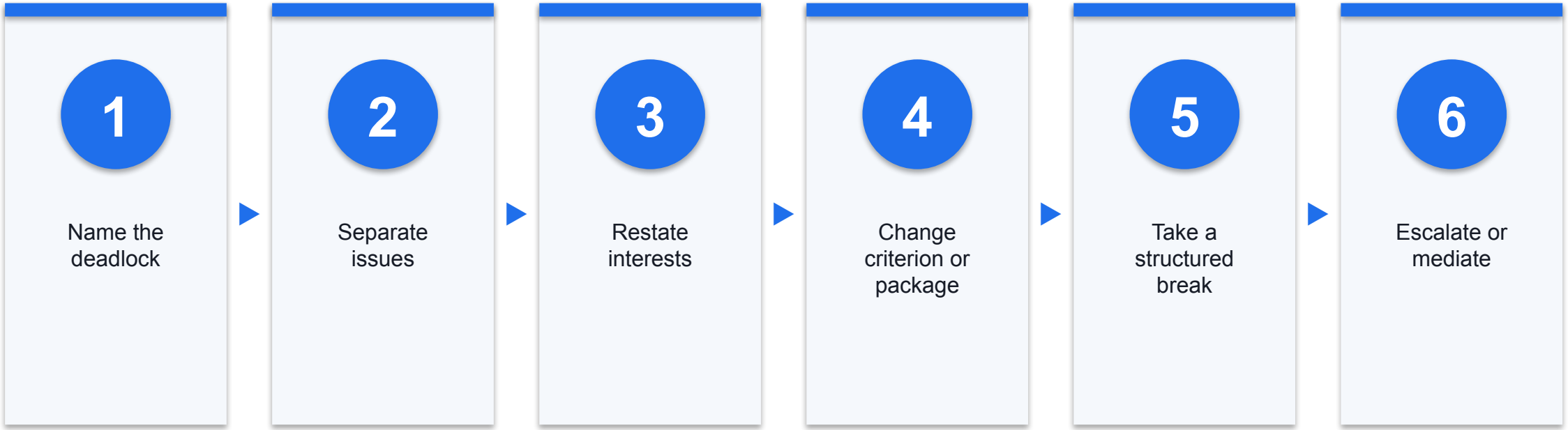
4

Learning

Their reactions reveal priorities without asking them to disclose a limit.

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Move from impasse to diagnosis



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Impasse breakers

1

Process

Change sequence, participants, venue, data or decision rule.

2

Substance

Add issues, phase commitments or use contingent agreements.

3

Relationship

Use a trusted senior sponsor or neutral facilitator.

4

Alternative

Pause, pursue BATNA and leave a credible route back.

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TOPIC 02 · K4 · K5 · K6 · A4 · A5

Say no cleanly

Perspective A

- State the boundary directly and briefly.
- Explain the legitimate interest, constraint or authority behind it.
- Offer an alternative path where one exists.

Perspective B

- Avoid a vague maybe that creates false expectations.
- Do not over-explain until the other side can litigate every detail.
- A respectful no can preserve trust better than a reluctant yes.

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When to walk away

1

Below reservation

The package is worse than the best credible alternative.

2

Unethical or unsafe

Deception, threats or illegal expectations make agreement unacceptable.

3

No authority

Required approval is unavailable and conditions cannot protect the commitment.

4

Implementation failure

The promised result cannot be resourced, measured or delivered.

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Close the agreement

1. Summarise the full package
2. Resolve ambiguity
3. Confirm authority
4. Document terms
5. Assign owners and dates
6. Set review and dispute path

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Terms that make agreement executable

1. **Scope**
   Deliverables, exclusions, quality and acceptance criteria.

2. **Commercial**
   Price, payment, incentives, credits and change control.

3. **Governance**
   Owners, reporting, escalation, review and dispute resolution.

4. **Risk**
   Confidentiality, liability, termination, continuity and transition.

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Consensus and consent

Perspective A

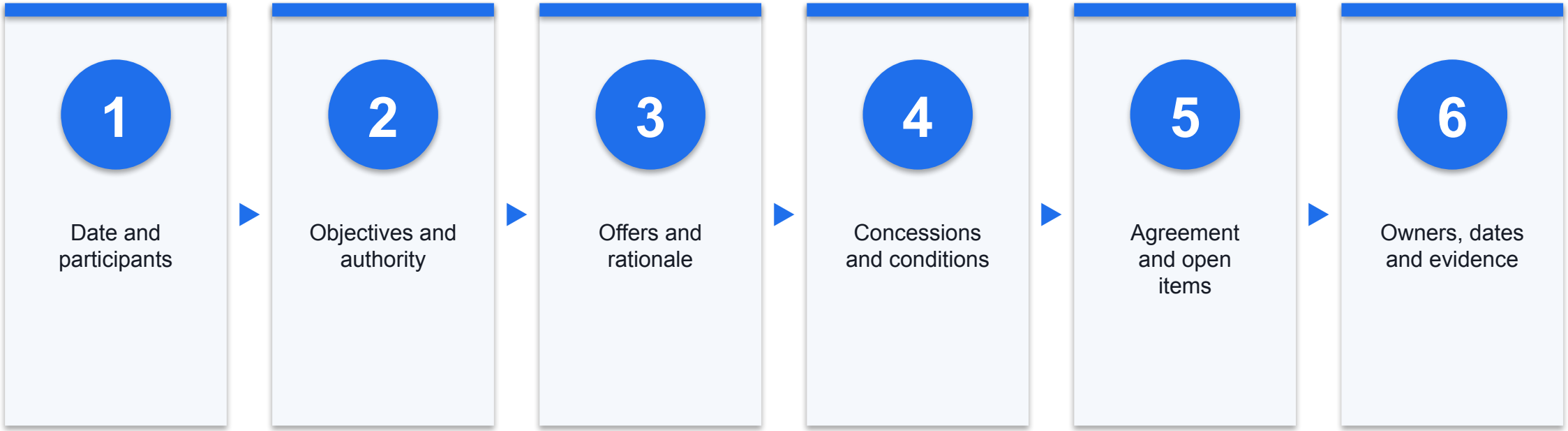
- Consensus seeks an outcome all required parties can support or live with.
- It is not unanimous enthusiasm or endless accommodation.
- Record reservations and implementation conditions.

Perspective B

- Formal consent requires the right person, authority and documentation.
- A handshake is not a substitute for agreed terms where writing is required.
- Confirm what is binding, provisional or subject to approval.

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Negotiation record



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Debrief the negotiation

1

Outcome

Compare result with target, reservation point and BATNA.

2

Process

Review preparation, information, tactics, decisions and turning points.

3

Relationship

Assess trust, fairness, communication and future cooperation.

4

Implementation

Track obligations, value realisation, disputes and lessons.

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WORKPLACE APPLICATION

Applied Activities — Negotiation Tactics

1

Activity 6

Anchor and Frame an Agency Retainer · K4 · K5 · A4

2

Activity 7

Recover a Logistics Service Relationship · K4 · K5 · A4

3

Activity 8

Break a Construction Variation Impasse · K5 · K6 · A4

4

Activity 9

Negotiate a Multi-Party Growth Investment · K4 · K5 · K6 · A4

5

Activity 10

Run and Debrief a Strategic Sustainability Partnership · K1 · K2 · K3 · K4 · K5 · K6 · A1 · A2 · A3 · A4 · A5

6

Evidence boundary

Realistic commercial cases; fictional training inputs are clearly labelled.

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Anchor and Frame an Agency Retainer

ACTIVITY 6

Represent an SME selecting a digital agency while balancing price, scope, performance evidence and launch speed.

You'll build

An opening package, counter-anchor script, question plan and concession ladder.

Tools / evidence: Agency proposals · value model · opening script · concession log

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ACTIVITY 6 · REAL-WORLD USE CASE

Case Scenario — Use Case and Training Guardrails

Business context

- Real-world use case: professional-service retainers combine scope, quality, staffing, intellectual property, metrics and commercial risk. The scenario is a realistic composite.
- Source: https://www.fuqua.duke.edu/programs/executive-education/business-negotiation-skills/negotiation-techniques

Training assumptions / limits

- The approved expected budget is SGD 24,000 monthly, with authority up to SGD 26,000 for defined senior staffing and performance reporting.
- The preferred agency's comparable work reduced acquisition cost by 12%, but attribution is not independently verified.
- The brand values launch readiness more than a small price reduction.

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ACTIVITY 6 · EDITABLE DECISION ARTIFACT

Agency Retainer Package

1. **Fee**
   Price and payment cadence
2. **Scope**
   Deliverables and exclusions
3. **Team**
   Seniority and continuity
4. **Metrics**
   Reporting and evidence
5. **IP**
   Ownership and usage rights
6. **Review**
   Pilot, renewal and exit

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ACTIVITY 6 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Activity Questions

1. Should the brand make the first offer, and why?
2. What evidence makes the anchor credible rather than arbitrary?
3. How should value be framed without overstating uncertain performance?
4. Which concessions should be conditional and reciprocal?

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ACTIVITY 6 · ACCEPTANCE TEST

Anchor and Frame an Agency Retainer

✅ Test it

The opening is ambitious but evidence-backed, covers at least six terms and includes no unconditional concession.

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LEARNING UNIT 02 · K4 · K5 · A4

Recover a Logistics Service Relationship

ACTIVITY 7

Renegotiate a logistics service-level agreement after repeated delivery failures while preserving peak-season capacity.

You'll build

A listening map, difficult-conversation plan, issue diagnosis and recovery package.

Tools / evidence: Incident timeline · SLA data · empathy map · recovery-scorecard template

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ACTIVITY 7 · REAL-WORLD USE CASE

Case Scenario — Use Case and Training Guardrails

Business context

- Real-world use case: service-recovery negotiations combine operational facts, attribution disputes, emotion, capacity constraints and future relationship value.
- Source: https://www.betterup.com/blog/negotiation-skills

Training assumptions / limits

- The SLA target is 95% on-time delivery; actual performance was 82% for six weeks.
- Thirty percent of late orders were changed by LionCity after the agreed cut-off.
- Service credits could total SGD 42,000, but capacity for the peak period is more valuable.

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ACTIVITY 7 · EDITABLE DECISION ARTIFACT

Service-Recovery Agreement

1. **Shared facts**
   SLA, forecast and incident data

2. **Root causes**
   System—not blame—diagnosis

3. **Reciprocal actions**
   Commitment from both parties

4. **Metrics**
   Thresholds and evidence source

5. **Owners**
   Accountable delivery roles

6. **Escalation**
   Trigger, date and consequence

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ACTIVITY 7 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Activity Questions

1. Which facts, interpretations and emotions must be separated?
2. What open and diagnostic questions could reveal the failure system?
3. How can the team acknowledge impact without accepting unsupported blame?
4. What reciprocal recovery commitments create measurable improvement?

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ACTIVITY 7 · ACCEPTANCE TEST

Recover a Logistics Service Relationship

✅ Test it

The record distinguishes fact from blame, captures both parties' interests and assigns measurable reciprocal actions with owners and dates.

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LEARNING UNIT 02 · K5 · K6 · A4

Break a Construction Variation Impasse

ACTIVITY 8

Facilitate a negotiation between a property owner and contractor over cost and schedule impact from an instructed design variation.

You'll build

An impasse diagnosis, precedent comparison, option set and escalation recommendation.

Tools / evidence: Variation chronology · contract extract · cost schedule · impasse worksheet

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ACTIVITY 8 · REAL-WORLD USE CASE

Case Scenario — Use Case and Training Guardrails

Business context

- Real-world use case: project variations frequently create disputes over entitlement, valuation, delay, evidence and authority. This simulation is educational and not legal advice.
- Source: https://www.pon.harvard.edu/freemium/negotiation-skills-negotiation-strategies-and-negotiation-techniques-to-help-you-become-a-better-negotiator/

Training assumptions / limits

- The contractor claims SGD 185,000; the owner's internal estimate is SGD 112,000.
- Independent quantity rates support a range of SGD 125,000–145,000 before delay impact.
- A 12-day delay would cost the owner SGD 36,000 in temporary premises.

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ACTIVITY 8 · EDITABLE DECISION ARTIFACT

Impasse Diagnosis Map

1. **Entitlement**
   Right to claim or resist
2. **Valuation**
   Rates, quantity and evidence
3. **Delay**
   Programme and mitigation
4. **Process**
   Notice, authority and sequence
5. **Relationship**
   Face, trust and future work
6. **Fallback**
   Escalation, mediation or BATNA

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ACTIVITY 8 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Activity Questions

1. Is the impasse about entitlement, valuation, delay, process or face?
2. Which precedents and objective criteria are genuinely comparable?
3. What package could separate undisputed and disputed components?
4. When should the parties pause, escalate, mediate or pursue BATNA?

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ACTIVITY 8 · ACCEPTANCE TEST

Break a Construction Variation Impasse

✅ Test it

The recommendation addresses each issue separately, uses at least two defensible criteria and preserves a clear non-agreement path.

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LEARNING UNIT 02 · K4 · K5 · K6 · A4

Negotiate a Multi-Party Growth Investment

ACTIVITY 9

Represent a founder balancing a lead investor, existing shareholders and key management during a growth funding round.

You'll build

A coalition map, issue package, precedent analysis and conditional term sheet.

Tools / evidence: Cap-table assumptions · term comparison · stakeholder map · package scorecard

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ACTIVITY 9 · REAL-WORLD USE CASE

Case Scenario — Use Case and Training Guardrails

Business context

- Real-world use case: investment negotiations involve valuation, governance, control, liquidity, incentives and long-term relationships among several parties. This is not investment or legal advice.
- Source: https://builtin.com/articles/negotiation-skills

Training assumptions / limits

- The lead investor proposes a SGD 32 million pre-money valuation.
- An alternative investor may offer a higher valuation but cannot decide for eight weeks.
- The board currently has three seats: two founder nominees and one independent.

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ACTIVITY 9 · EDITABLE DECISION ARTIFACT

Multi-Party Coalition Map

Commercial and process lens

- Founder — Capital and autonomy
- Lead investor — Return and governance
- Shareholders — Dilution and protection

Relationship and decision lens

- Management — Incentives and execution
- Board — Fiduciary oversight
- Approval — Who can support or block

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ACTIVITY 9 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Activity Questions

1. Which parties can form supportive or blocking coalitions?
2. Which terms are economically linked even if negotiated separately?
3. What precedent comparisons are misleading without context?
4. Which package best balances capital, control, incentives and relationship value?

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ACTIVITY 9 · ACCEPTANCE TEST

Negotiate a Multi-Party Growth Investment

✅ Test it

The board brief covers every material stakeholder, compares three packages and explains why each cited precedent is or is not comparable.

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LEARNING UNIT 02 · K1 · K2 · K3 · K4 · K5 · K6 · A1 · A2 · A3 · A4 · A5

Run and Debrief a Strategic Sustainability Partnership

ACTIVITY 10

Negotiate a partnership between an urban property operator and a clean-energy solutions company to deploy solar and energy-management services across commercial sites.

You'll build

A completed preparation brief, role-play, negotiation log, term sheet and after-action review.

Tools / evidence: Confidential role briefs · issue matrix · term-sheet template · observer rubric · debrief log

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ACTIVITY 10 · REAL-WORLD USE CASE

Case Scenario — Use Case and Training Guardrails

Business context

- Real-world use case: strategic sustainability partnerships combine capital, performance, access, data, branding, risk and long-term governance. The organisations and figures are fictional training inputs.
- Source: https://www.pon.harvard.edu/daily/negotiation-skills-daily/top-10-negotiation-skills/

Training assumptions / limits

- Estimated project investment is SGD 3.2 million funded primarily by SunGrid.
- Modelled annual savings are SGD 620,000 with a plus/minus 20% uncertainty band.
- CivicSquare can offer five sites but only three have completed structural surveys.

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ACTIVITY 10 · EDITABLE DECISION ARTIFACT

Executable Partnership Terms

1. **Value**
   Economics and savings share
2. **Performance**
   Baseline and verification
3. **Access**
   Sites, safety and timing
4. **Data**
   Security, ownership and use
5. **Governance**
   Owners, review and escalation
6. **Exit**
   Handover, liability and termination

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ACTIVITY 10 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Activity Questions

1. What outcomes, BATNAs, roles, evidence and cultural/process assumptions should each team prepare?
2. Which opening package creates a credible anchor across value, risk and implementation?
3. How should teams respond to pressure, impasse and late requests while preserving reciprocity?
4. Does the final record make commitments, owners, evidence and review conditions executable?

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ACTIVITY 10 · ACCEPTANCE TEST

Run and Debrief a Strategic Sustainability Partnership

✅ Test it

The submission contains a complete negotiation log and executable term sheet or no-deal rationale, with explicit mapping to A1–A5 and all six knowledge areas.

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LEARNING UNIT RECAP

Recap — Negotiation Tactics

1. **Anchor and Frame an Agency Retainer**
   Use a supportable opening offer, framing and package design to negotiate a marketing agency retainer.

2. **Recover a Logistics Service Relationship**
   Use listening, empathy, questions and emotional regulation with a defensive service provider.

3. **Break a Construction Variation Impasse**
   Diagnose and resolve an impasse using objective criteria, issue separation and escalation choices.

4. **Negotiate a Multi-Party Growth Investment**
   Use coalition mapping, package trades and precedent analysis in a multi-party term-sheet negotiation.

5. **Run and Debrief a Strategic Sustainability Partnership**
   Integrate preparation, tactics, closure and recording in a complete team negotiation simulation.

6. **Evidence habit**
   Separate facts, hypotheses, limits and training assumptions.

7. **Negotiation habit**
   Link every movement to an interest, condition, authority and record.

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WRAP-UP

Agreement Is the Start of Implementation

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COURSE SUMMARY

What You Achieved

1

LO1

Identify negotiation outcomes, the context of negotiation and relevant background information required to prepare for negotiation.

2

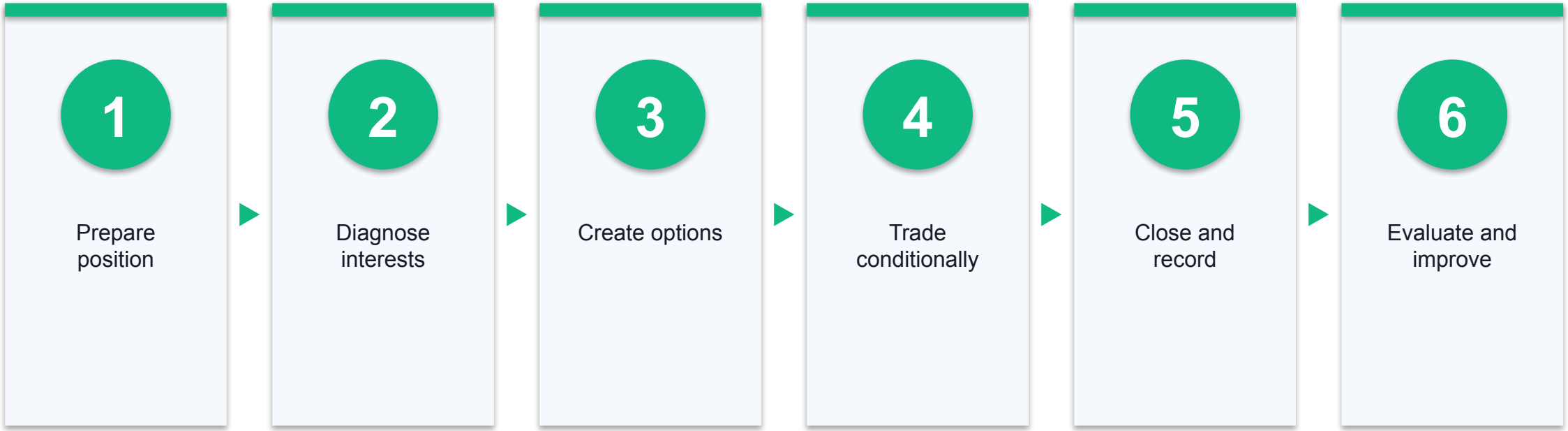
LO2

Apply negotiation techniques during negotiation and record negotiations for post-negotiation evaluation.

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TAKEAWAY

The complete negotiation discipline



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COURSE ENRICHMENT

Evidence Sources

1. **Course page and approved outcomes**
   https://www.tertiarycourses.com.sg/wsq-unlocking-business-potential-with-strategic-negotiation-tactics.html

2. **Asana — negotiation skills**
   https://asana.com/resources/negotiation-skills

3. **Built In — negotiation skills and examples**
   https://builtin.com/articles/negotiation-skills

4. **Harvard Program on Negotiation — top negotiation skills**
   https://www.pon.harvard.edu/daily/negotiation-skills-daily/top-10-negotiation-skills/

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COURSE ENRICHMENT

Evidence Sources — Continued

1. **Esade — negotiation techniques**
   https://www.esade.edu/beyond/en/negotiation-techniques/

2. **Duke Fuqua — negotiation techniques**
   https://www.fuqua.duke.edu/programs/executive-education/business-negotiation-skills/negotiation-techniques

3. **Crowdspring — negotiation guide**
   https://www.crowdspring.com/blog/negotiation/

4. **Indeed Singapore — negotiation skills**
   https://sg.indeed.com/career-advice/career-development/negotiation-skills

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COURSE ENRICHMENT

Evidence Sources — Continued

1. **Harvard PON — negotiation skills and techniques**
   https://www.pon.harvard.edu/freemium/negotiation-skills-negotiation-strategies-and-negotiation-techniques-to-help-you-become-a-better-negotiator/

2. **Harvard PON — types of negotiation skills**
   https://www.pon.harvard.edu/daily/negotiation-skills-daily/types-of-negotiation-skills/

3. **BetterUp — negotiation skills**
   https://www.betterup.com/blog/negotiation-skills

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LMS

Courseware and Assessment on the LMS

https://lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com/

Courseware

Download the current slides and Learner Guide.

Assessment

Open and complete the WA then Case Study.

Submission

Upload completed answers and complete the sign-off process.

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FINAL ASSESSMENT

Assessment Reminder

WA-SAQ · 4:00–5:00pm

- 6 open-ended questions
- K1–K6
- Open book

Case Study · 5:00–6:00pm

- 2 integrated questions
- A1–A5
- Open book

Finish

- Submit on LMS
- Digital attendance
- Sign summary record

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ON ASSESSMENT DAY

Assessment Flow

1. TRAQOM / SSG attendance
2. Assessment digital attendance
3. Sit WA then Case Study
4. Submit answers on the LMS
5. Sign the Assessment Summary Record

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STRATEGIC NEGOTIATION

Thank You

Prepare with discipline, listen for interests, trade conditionally and record what implementation requires.

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